

LESSON TWO

VOLUME PROFILE BASICS

Shelves, ledges, HVNs and LVNs. The structures inside the profile that do not move when price does, and how to turn them into real levels.

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Ether, the free side of Ethos

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This guide pairs with the video. [Watch it](#) for the live walkthrough, keep this next to the charts.



What the profile is showing you

Lesson 1 gave you the auction: balance, imbalance and the value area. This lesson is about the tool that draws it, the volume profile, and the two structures inside it that most traders never learn to read.

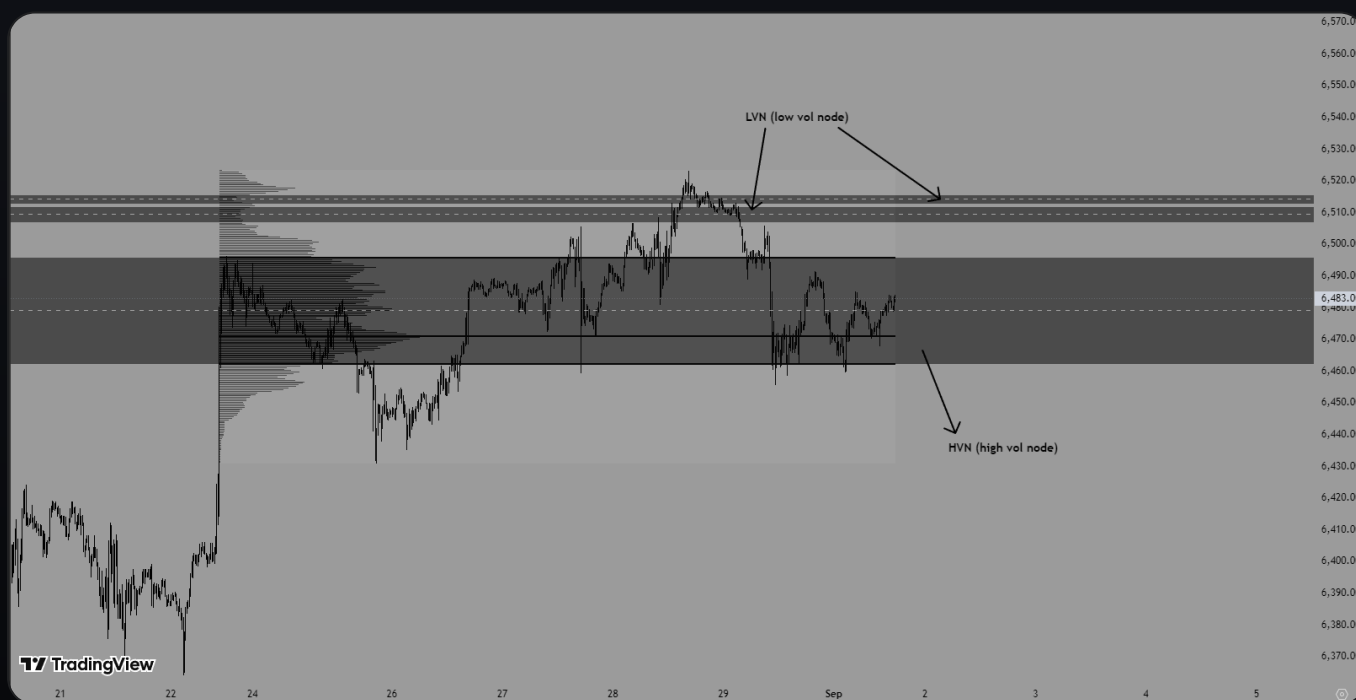
The profile shows you **volume at price**, not volume in time. It is a map of where the business actually happened.

HVN, HIGH VOLUME NODE

A price where volume built up. The market spent time here and agreed here. Price gets drawn back to these shelves and slows down inside them.

LVN, LOW VOLUME NODE

A price where volume fell away. The market rejected it and moved fast. Price tends to react at these and traverse them quickly.



HVN and LVN marked on NQ. The build-ups and the fall-offs are the map: value sits where the volume sits.



Shelves and ledges

Inside every profile the volume builds up, holds, and then fades away. Name those pieces and you can trade them.



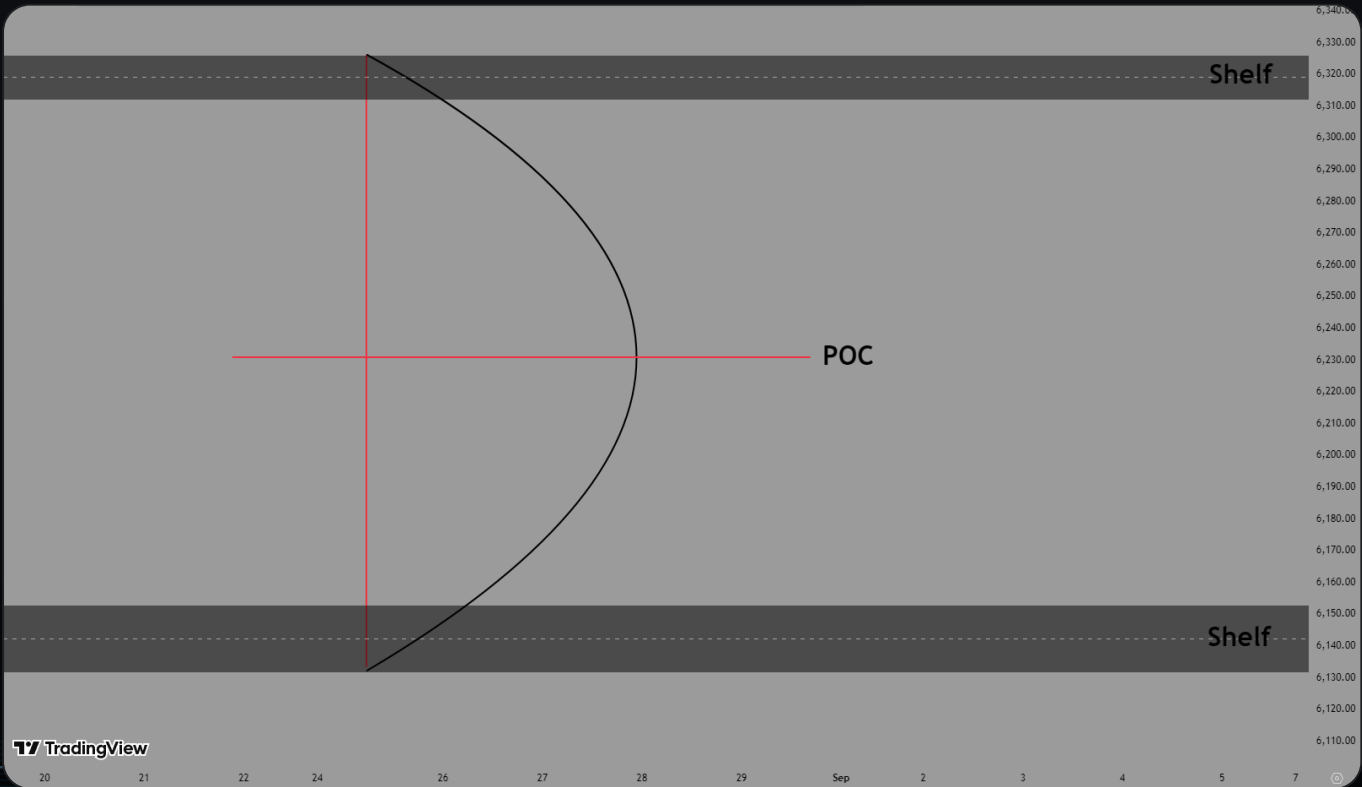
Shelves marked on the chart. Each one is a zone of agreed business with clean edges either side.

THE SHELF

Everything in between the lines. The body of agreed business, the zone price rotates inside and returns to.

THE LEDGE

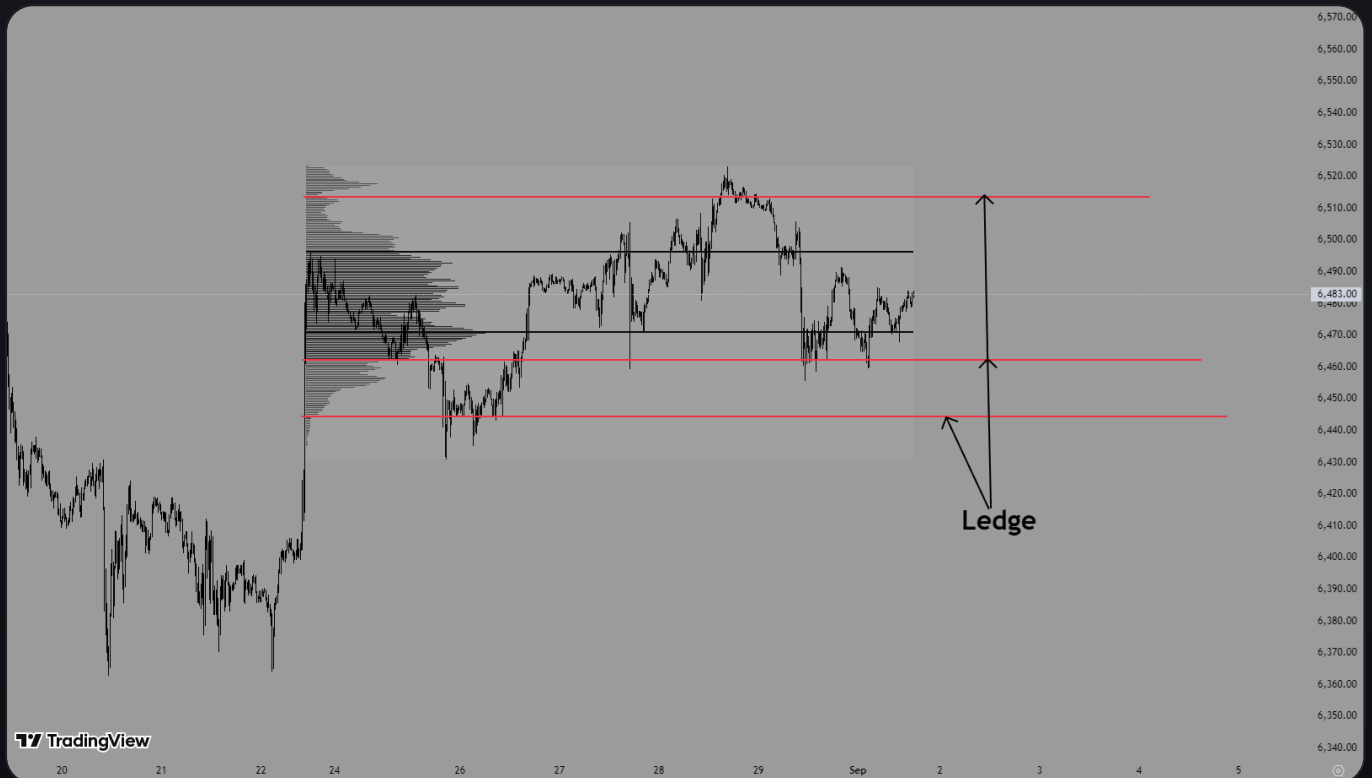
The lines themselves, the extremes of the shelf. The exact price where the build-up starts or the fade-away begins.



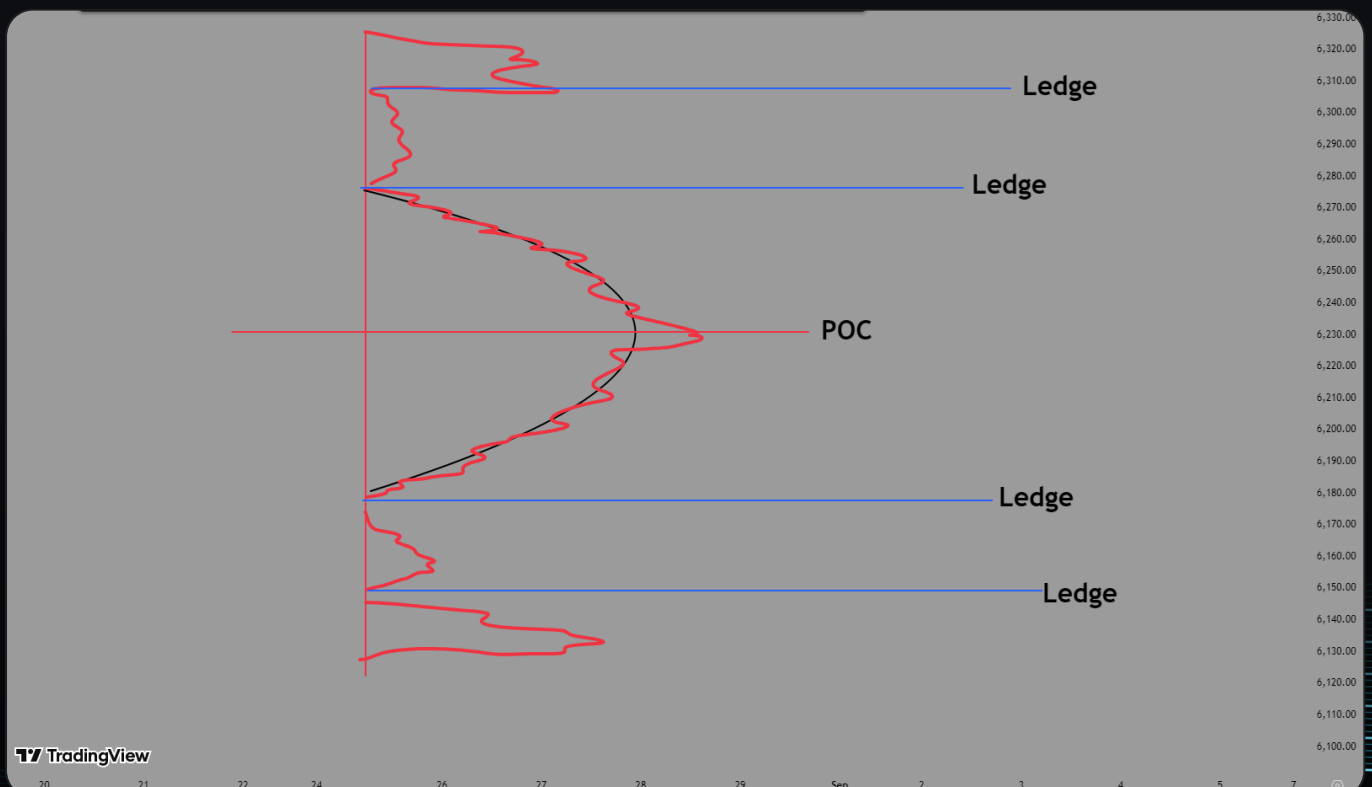
Real extremes vs lagging levels

Here is the part that actually builds an edge. VAH, VAL and POC are useful, but they recalculate as price moves. They drift with the session, like a lagging indicator. A ledge does not move.

Shelves and ledges are **real extremes. They are structure, not statistics.**



Ledges marked with the red lines. These edges were set by real business and they stay where they were set.



The simpler view again: four ledges around the POC. Fixed reference points on a profile that otherwise keeps changing.

Naked POCs and composites

Two ideas turn the profile from a single-session tool into a genuine map: naked POCs and composite profiles.

NAKED POC

A prior session's POC that price has not traded back to yet. Untested, it acts like a magnet, the market tends to return and tag it. A list of naked POCs above and below is a ready made target list.

COMPOSITE PROFILE

Merge several days or weeks into one profile. The HVNs and LVNs that survive across all that data are the levels the whole market respects, far stronger than any single day's.

The logic is the same at every timescale. A shelf on a 5 minute profile is a scalp level, the same shelf on a composite weekly profile is a swing level. Zoom the profile to match the trade you are hunting.

HOW TO USE THEM

Mark naked POCs as targets and composite HVNs as your heavyweight levels. When a naked POC lines up with a composite shelf, that is a level worth building a whole session around.



Trading the structure

Price is likely to react at the sensitive areas, the build-ups and the fall-offs. That makes shelves and ledges your reaction zones, the places where a trade can exist.



Trade the ledge, not the middle of the shelf

The edge of the structure is where the decision happens. Inside the shelf is rotation, chop and noise. At the ledge the market either defends the business or abandons it.



Only with the confirmation correct

A ledge on its own is a line. Watch the DOM and the footprint at the level: absorption, aggression, the tape picking a side. No confirmation, no trade, same rule as every level in this method.



Stack it with other levels

A ledge that lines up with another reference, VWAP, a prior value area edge, an old POC, is worth far more than either level alone. Confluence is the filter. VWAP gets its own lesson later in the series.

THE SEQUENCE

Structure first, confirmation second, execution last. The profile tells you where the trade lives, the tape tells you when to take it.



The shelf checklist

Five checks before you trade any profile structure. Run them in order, every time.



Mark the nodes

HVNs and LVNs on the ranges that matter: yesterday, the overnight, the current balance.



Draw the ledges

The exact prices where each build-up starts and each fade-away begins. Those lines are the trade locations.



Label the shelves

Know which zones are agreed business. Inside them you expect rotation, not follow-through.



Check for confluence

Does a ledge line up with VWAP, a value area edge or an old POC? Stacked levels first, lone levels last.



Wait for the tape

DOM and footprint at the level. The structure is context, the confirmation is the trigger.





Now trade the structure.

You can now read where the business happened and where its edges are. Inside Ethos, the mentorship, you learn the KG models that trade those edges, with live sessions three times a week.



Mark the nodes before the open

HVNs, LVNs and the ledges around them. Five minutes of structure.



Respect the ledges

The edges of business are the levels. The middle of the shelf is noise.



Confirm with order flow

Structure is context, the tape is the trigger.

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